



Banana connectors

Now it's time to go primal. Banana plugs are what we call single-wire connectors. Each of them have only one conductor and thus carry only one type of signal. They are mostly used in couples.

Most notably found on a lot of amplifiers, loudspeakers and other high-fidelity sound systems, they're preferred for their ease of usage and aesthetics. They also come in a customizable segment as each connector is manually attached with a wire. They are available in a variety of designs, but the basic idea to screw the wire stays.

## Conclusion

Because of the number of options available out there it becomes even more important to know about as many connectors and interfaces as possible. Although we're dominated by phone connectors and HDMI, they're not exclusive choices. HDMI takes the league in video/audio department with Thunderbolt pushing hard in the same segment as well. Phone connector is still prominent and growing, but is not the best quality option. With USB Type-C support, Thunderbolt wants to take away 3.5mm jack's job. On the mobile front, Type-C and Lightning have already started extinguishing the phone connector's existence. For sound recording, XLR has taken its major piece of the pie and holds its ground very well. Speakon has absolutely shattered the competition in loudspeaker and amp systems. Even though TOSLINK never got to live a bright future, its presence in modern systems makes it something to keep an eye on.

If you're looking to improve audio experience through your mobile device, you can look into Type-C or Lightning peripherals. It should be noted that the market is small for this and it'll be harder to ditch the headphone